

GSET – Next Operational Actions

Prepared by Ted • 13 May 2026 • For Olly

****The thing being built:**** A YouTube series of ~20 episodes, ~8 minutes each, made from the existing audiobook ("podcast") of **The Greatest Story Ever Told**. ~160 mins of new filming to pair with the audio. YouTube channel already set up. Graphics in flight. No domain. No landing page. No spin-off platforms. ****Just episodes on the channel, in the right form, on time.****

This is the operational do-list to get them filmed, edited, and live.

The five operational workstreams

Everything below sits inside one of these:

1. ****Rights**** – written permission from Hodder/audiobook publisher to cut, re-cut, and monetise.
2. ****Editor**** – who edits 20 episodes + shorts.
3. ****Actor**** – one performer, 20 episodes, batched.
4. ****Studio**** – where the 2–3 day batch shoot happens.
5. ****Cost**** – total spend signed off before any commitments.

RIGHTS – this week

1. Send the Hodder rights email today

- 10 min. Email Andy Lyon at Hodder Faith. Explicitly ask for written confirmation on:
- Use of audiobook audio in 8-minute YouTube episodes
 - Editorial rights to cut chapters into episodes
 - ****YouTube monetisation of those episodes****
 - Use of audio clips for promo shorts

Template is ready in `gset-operator-playbook.md` Step 1 – add the monetisation line.
****Done when:**** sent. Reply may take a week – don't block other workstreams on it.

2. Confirm where the master audiobook audio lives

Either Hodder has the masters and we license access, or we have files we already paid for and need to re-license usage. Worth asking Andy in the same email: "How do we get clean audio masters by Mon 9 Jun for the edit?"

****Done when:**** clear answer on file delivery path and date.

EDITOR – hire by Fri 23 May

3. Write the editor brief

60 min. Spec the role tight to this format:

- Comfortable layering audiobook audio over picture
- Cuts to 8:30–10:30 mins for YouTube mid-roll monetisation
- Builds shorts (~30–60s) from each episode's offcuts
- Available for ~9 months of fortnightly cuts after the shoot
- Retainer £1,500–2,000/mo

Ask Felix who BGV's used before. If nothing usable, post to People Per Hour / Production Hub.

****Done when:**** brief is written, 3+ candidates lined up.

4. Interview 3, hire one

By end of next week. Get a 60-second test edit from each: audiobook audio + any B-roll, their choice. Pick on craft, not pitch.

****Done when:** contract signed.**

ACTOR — longlist by Wed 21 May, sign by Fri 30 May

5. Build the longlist (5–6 names)

Criteria:

- Face you can watch for ~3 hours of cumulative screen time across 20 episodes
- Physically and tonally credible for the material
- Available for 2–3 batch shoot days in mid-June
- Single fee covering all 20 episodes + buyout

Mix known and unknown. A recognisable name accelerates launch; an unknown is cheaper and easier to lock in.

****Done when:** longlist sat in a doc, top 2 contacted.**

6. Sign one actor

Decision by Fri 30 May. Budget envelope £2–5k depending on name. Single-fee buyout covering all 20 episodes, all platforms, in perpetuity. Don't agree to per-episode fees.

****Done when:** signed contract in hand.**

STUDIO — book by Fri 6 Jun

7. Get 2–3 quotes for a 2-day batch shoot

London likely. One neutral set, lighting setup once, all 20 chapters back-to-back. Ask Felix for previous BGV studios. Budget envelope £1.5–3k/day inclusive of crew (cam op + sound).

****Done when:** quotes in.**

8. Book the studio

Two days: Tue 16 — Wed 17 Jun (anniversary 19 Jun, tight against launch). Pay deposit.

****Done when:** dates locked, deposit paid.**

COST — signed off by Fri 16 May

9. Get year-1 budget signed off

One message to Jesse with the line items:

Line £
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Editor retainer (9 months × £1.8k) 16,200
Actor fee + buyout 3,500
Studio (2 days + crew) 4,500
Sound design / mix-in (occasional, post) 1,200
Contingency 10% 2,540
Total **~27,940**

Roughly half the original drama-version budget. No paid media, no landing page, no domain — none of that is in scope.

****Done when:** Jesse replied with £ approved.**

RUN-UP — what happens after the four hires

10. Confirm the chapter map (week of 26 May)

Half-page table: ep # → audiobook chapter → timestamp range → working episode title. If chapters don't divide into 8-min units, decide whether to combine or split. Flag

to Hodder if it changes the cut materially.

11. Pre-prod with actor (week of 9 June)

Read-through, blocking, basic mood per chapter. Half-day with actor + editor + you.

12. Shoot – Tue 16 / Wed 17 June

All 20 chapters in two days. Editor on set day 2 to check footage usability before everyone leaves.

13. Edit ep 1 + trailer in parallel – Wed 17 / Thu 18 June

Editor's only job for 48 hours.

14. Launch – Thursday 19 June 2026

Episode 1 live. 90-sec trailer live. Channel public.

What Ted needs you to decide

1. **Budget envelope to send Jesse:** £28k as estimated above, or pad to £32k for unknowns?

2. **Actor route:** known name (faster reach, £4–5k) or unknown (cheaper, £2–3k, takes longer to find the right one)?

3. **Studio:** who do you want me to ask Felix about first – does he have a preferred London studio for this kind of single-set shoot?

Open questions for Ollie

– Is there an existing actor relationship we should approach first, or do we go cold?

– Is the audiobook 20 chapters as-is, or are we re-cutting?

– Who is point on Hodder if Andy Lyon goes quiet?

Related: `gset-operator-playbook.md`, `gset-pivot-action-steps-2026-05-12.md`